

Ancient History





About the Course

Study history stories about the ancient civilizations that lived from 100 BC to 350 AD. View images and reference atlases and maps to set the people and events in their time and place. Update History Charts and Book of Centuries as appropriate for student level.

This topic is included in the following course(s): History: Grades 5-6 (U.S.), History: Grades 5-6 (Canada)



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
5-6	Ancient History: Grades 5-6 1 time/week 25 min	The Bronze Bow Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
History: Grades 5-6 (U.S.)				
	U.S. History: Grades 4-6		World History: Grades 4-6	Ancient History: Grades 5-6
History: Grades 5-6 (Canada)				
	Canadian History: Grades 5-6		World History: Grades 4-6	Ancient History: Grades 5-6



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

History: Grades 5-6 (Canada)

☐ Read the document in the Quick Links about History Timelines and Charts.

☐ We encourage you to pick a biography for each term to read in the afternoons. The Bookshelf has many recommendations.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Ancient History: Grades 5-6



The Bronze Bow



Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Related Course Quick Links

- ∞ [Extra Helpings](#)
- ∞ [History Charts & Timeline Scope & Sample](#)
- ∞ [Century Chart](#)
- ∞ [Grade 5 Canadian History Chart Prompts](#)
- ∞ [Grade 5 U.S. History Chart Prompts](#)
- ∞ [Grade 6 Canadian History Chart Prompts](#)
- ∞ [Grade 6 U.S. History Chart Prompta](#)
- ∞ [Foundations \(See Section 15: History.\)](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Ancient History: Grades 5-6

How To Teach



Prepare

- Read through the lesson and gather any materials or find any necessary links.
- If you have not already read the book, you may want to read the selected pages in advance.



Recap

- Connect to previous lessons by asking students to recall where they left off.
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them a picture from the reading, sharing something the teacher remembers, or prompting them with the first sentence of the last reading. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, teachers might consider continuing anyway (with a shorter reading this time) or repeating the previous lesson, depending on the reading and the nature of the book.



Introduce

- Use a picture, map, or engaging question to pique the student's interest in the day's lesson.
- If necessary, you may talk about one or two unfamiliar words that will be crucial to understanding.



Read

- Read the day's passage out loud. When reading to pre-readers, point to the words as you read, even if it seems like they aren't paying attention.
- Move at the student's pace for the lesson time rather than a particular number of pages. It is vitally important that teachers not try to 'force feed' a student more than they can consume in one sitting.
- Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.



Narrate

- Have students retell the passage orally.
- Alternatively, learners may use words, pictures, Legos, dolls, etc., to process and convey ideas in the manner most natural to them.
- Teachers may take turns to model.
- Narration is a complex skill requiring the coordination of several parts of the brain. If a student struggles to narrate in general, with a specific subject or book, or on one day but not others, then this is an opportunity to learn. Observe when they struggle with this or any other activity today. Notice facial expressions and body language; listen to what they say about why it is hard or how they feel about it. Take note of these observations for later, tell them that you see how hard they

are working, and then offer whatever support they need to end on a positive note. If necessary, take a break for the day.



Discuss

- Give the student an opportunity to share thoughts on the lesson and any connections made.
- To stimulate discussion, you could ask them what they thought about the passage or ask an open-ended question.

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 1

Materials: Bronze Bow

→ INTRO

The Bronze Bow, winner of the 1962 Newbery Medal, is set in Galilee during the time of Jesus's ministry (approximately 28–33 AD). Galilee had occupied by Rome for almost 100 years when the story takes place, and the people longed for freedom from Roman oppression. As we read the story, we'll explore both the Galilee region and the culture of Rome during this time period.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Read: CHAPTER 1

- Why do you think Daniel trusts Joel and Malthace so quickly?
- What would you miss most if you had to leave your home?

→ MAPWORK:

- Find Galilee on p. ___ of your Bible Atlas or [on this map](#). Notice that Galilee was an area near the Sea of Galilee, not the name of a city. (The name Galilee Hebrew word galil, which translates to "district," "circle," or "region".)
- Now locate the Sea of Galilee and the town of Capernaum. This was the town the twins said they were moving to.
- Much of the story takes place in the village of Ketzah, but this is a fictitious town. In the book it is said to be on the northern shore of the Sea of Galilee, three miles from Capernaum. Can you estimate about where this would have been located on your map?

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: (Optional, as time allows) [The Culture at the Time of Jesus' Birth](#)

∞ Video Link: (Optional, as time allows) [Galilee At The Time of Jesus](#)

WEEK 2 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 2

Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What do you remember about Daniel and his conversation with the twin brother and sister (Joel and Malthace)?

→ BACKGROUND

Under Roman law, enslaved people had no rights and were regarded as the property of their masters. They could be bought, sold, and mistreated at will. They were unable to own property, enter into a contract, or legally marry.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.15-26 "'Wait here,' Daniel"-"man sleeps free."

- How does Samson's condition show the harshness of the ancient world?
- What early signs do we see about Rosh's character and leadership?

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: (Optional, as time allows) [Meet a Roman Legionary](#)

Note: Though this video shows Roman Legionary in England rather than Israel, the uniforms and lifestyle would have been very similar.

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 3 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 3

Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What happened with Sampson the slave in the last chapter?

→ BACKGROUND

Daniel had run away from Amalek, a cruel blacksmith, where he was a bonded servant. A bonded servant worked for a master, usually to learn a trade or to pay off debt, for a set number of years. Although biblical law mandated protections for indentured Hebrew servants, Amalek treated Daniel cruelly. Unable to endure the abuse, Daniel broke his bond and fled into the mountains making him a runaway and a fugitive from justice.

Daniel's grandmother mentions a "pauper's share" of grain in this chapter. This Biblical practice was called gleaning. Land owners were to leave the edges of their fields unharvested so that the poor and widows could gather the grain to feed themselves. This wasn't a handout - it took a lot of work to gather the grain, separate it, grind it, and turn it into a course flour to make bread! Do you remember any Bible stories that mention gleaning?

Look closely for details on how the Jewish Sabbath is observed during this chapter. The Sabbath would have been observed from Friday night to Saturday night. Sabbath comes from the Hebrew word shabbat, which literally translates to "to rest" or "to cease".

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Chapter 3

- Why do you think Simon says that he and Rosh "work for the same end, but we don't exactly see eye to eye."
- Why is Daniel reluctant to visit his grandmother and sister? How does he feel once he is there?

→ VIEW

∞ Website Link: (Optional, as time allows) [Gleaning by Hand](#) (With use of some modern tools.)

WEEK 4 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 4

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What do you remember about Simon's visit to Daniel and Daniel's visit to his grandmother in the last chapter?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Chapter 4

- Why does Jesus' message seem strange to Daniel?
- Why do you think Daniel leave his grandmother's house to go back to the cave?

→ MAPWORK:

- Find Nazareth on your map.
- Find Chorazin where the grandmother sells his sister's weaving on the map.

→ VIEW

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

∞ Video Link: (Optional, as time allows) [1st Century Nazareth Village Comes to Life](#)

∞ Video Link: (Optional, as time allows) [1st Century Synagogue](#)

WEEK 5 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 5

Main Idea/Subtitle

 Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

In this chapter, Daniel travels to the city of Capernaum. Nestled on the northern shore of the Sea of Galilee, Capernaum was a prosperous fishing village and busy hub of daily life in first-century Galilee. Its rich waters and location along major trade routes made it a natural gathering place. It was also the home base of Jesus during his years of ministry.

Also mentioned in this chapter, Tiberias was built around 20 AD by Herod Antipas and named for the reigning Roman Emperor. Situated along the western shore of the Sea of Galilee near 17 natural hot springs, it served as the Roman capital of Galilee and was meant to show off Roman life. Its construction over an ancient cemetery made it ritually unclean under Jewish law. This initially kept observant Jews away, though it later became a major center of Jewish scholarship.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Chapter 5 (The next lesson has fewer pages if you need to save part of this chapter for next time.)

- Why did the people in Capernaum act differently toward the Roman soldiers than Daniel did? Was one right or wrong?
- How does Hezron's approach to the Roman occupation differ from the Zealots? Which do you think is wiser?

→ MAPWORK:

- Locate town of Capernaum.
- Locate the town of Tiberias.

→ VIEW

∞ Website Link: (Optional, as time allows) [Exploring the Ancient City of Tiberius](#)

∞ Website Link: (Optional, as time allows) [Capernaum Tour](#)

WEEK 6 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 6

Main Idea/Subtitle

 Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What do you remember about Capernaum or Joel's family home there?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Chapter 6

- Why do Joel and Thacia help Daniel even though hiding him could bring trouble to their household?
- Daniel feels insulted by the Roman soldier's command. Was his reaction understandable, wise, both, or neither? Why?

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 7 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 7

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.7

- What did you learn about Daniel's family and why he hates the Romans?
- Does Daniel want justice or revenge? How are they different?

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 8 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 8

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Many people in first-century Judea expected a Messiah who would overthrow Rome, but Jesus' work pointed to a different kind of kingdom.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Chapter 8

- Why do you think Simon's decision surprises Daniel?
- How does Jesus' healing and teaching differ from Rosh's plans for freedom?

→ MAPWORK:

- The family with the injured boy walked from Cana to Bethsaida. Find Bethsaida on your map. Then find Cana on your map. The distance walking would be roughly 30 miles.

WEEK 9 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 9

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Chapters 9 & 10

- How does Rosh treat Daniel? How does this compare to how the villagers treat Daniel?
- How does Daniel's return home begin to change him?

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 10 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 10

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Blacksmithing

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Chapter 11

- How does Daniel's life begin to change in this chapter? How does Leah begin to change?
- What does Daniel learn about sacrifice in this chapter?

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 11 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 11

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Bronze Bow

→ BACKGROUND

Tax collectors

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

- Why do you think the group of boys is growing so quickly?
- Why do you think the Roman soldier was around so often and then quit coming by? Do you think it due to the meetings or something else?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Chapter 12

WEEK 12 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 12

→ EXAMS ANSWER QUESTION(S) RELATED TO COURSE.
QUESTIONS WILL COME FROM: BRONZE BOW

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 1 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 13

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ BACKGROUND

Weaving, food preparation, market stalls

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Chapter 13

- Why do you think Thacia was able to reach Leah?
- How does Daniel's life now compare to his life with Rosh?

WEEK 2 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 14

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.14

- Why does Daniel return to Rosh? Why does he leave again?
- How does Daniel's time in the village change the way he sees life on the mountain?

WEEK 3 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 15

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

This chapter mentions the month of Ab, which would be in July and August.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.15

- How does Daniel feel about his morning visits to the city versus the evening?
- Has the crowd or conditions changed since the first time Daniel heard Jesus speak?

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 4 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 16

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

→ INTRO

tetrarch—the half-Jew, Herod Antipas, who had been appointed to rule over them

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Chapter 16

- Why do you think Joel is willing to risk so much?
- Why do you think Thacia says there is beauty in being alive in Galilee when it is occupied by Romans?

WEEK 5 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 17

Main Idea/Subtitle

 Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ BACKGROUND

Catapult, siege of Sepphoris, Roman response to uprising - importance of firm rule

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Chapter 17

- What is the difference between a leader who serves people and one who uses people?
- Why is Daniel becoming uneasy with the local boys and with Rosh?

→ PROMPT

∞ Image Link: Title of Image

WEEK 6 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 18

Main Idea/Subtitle

 Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ BACKGROUND

The month of Ebul would be August / September. Being sent to the Roman galleys

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Chapters 18 & 19

- How do Daniel and Rosh compare as leaders?
- In what ways was their mission to rescue Joel a success? A failure?
- What was your reaction to Sampson's sacrifice?

WEEK 7 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 19

Main Idea/Subtitle

 Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

The month of Tishri is September / October. Day of Atonement

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.20

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

- Why do you think Joel still wants to follow Rosh after being captured?
- Why do Daniel and Joel believe Jesus may be the leader they are looking for rather than Rosh?

→ BACKGROUND

∞ Video Link: [What Normal Life Was Like In The 1st Century AD](#) Watch from beginning to 10:10. We will watch the rest in future lessons.
Teacher's Note: One man says Jesus was possibly a stone mason instead of a carpenter due to translation of the Greek word tekton as "master builder" instead of the traditional English translation as "carpenter".

WEEK 8 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 20

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ BACKGROUND

Time for lots more today

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ch.21

- Why is Jesus not the kind of leader Daniel expected?
- Why is it so difficult for Daniel to let go of hatred?

→ BACKGROUND

∞ Video Link: [What Normal Life Was Like In The 1st Century AD](#) Watch from 10:10-19:45. We will watch the rest in future lessons.

WEEK 9 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 21

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Information

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Chapter 22

- Is Daniel justified in his anger? In his treatment of Leah?
- What does this chapter show about the cost of refusing to forgive?

→ BACKGROUND

∞ Video Link: [What Normal Life Was Like In The 1st Century AD](#) Watch from start to 19:45-29:13. We will watch the rest in future lessons.

WEEK 10 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 22

Main Idea/Subtitle

Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ BACKGROUND

Time for more today

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

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Term 2

Chapter 23

- How does Simon's understanding of Jesus differ from Daniel's?
- Why does Daniel feel so disappointed after talking with Simon?

→ BACKGROUND

∞ Video Link: [What Normal Life Was Like In The 1st Century AD](#) Watch from start to 29:13-38:13. We will watch the rest in future lessons.

WEEK 11 ☐ 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 23

Main Idea/Subtitle

📖 Materials: Bronze Bow

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

Jesus' message of loving enemies eventually spread throughout the Roman Empire and challenged Roman ideas of power, revenge, and domination. Roman becoming Christian.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Chapter 24

- How has Daniel changed by the end of the story?
- Why is Daniel's invitation to Marcus such a powerful ending?
- How does the meaning of the bronze bow change at the end of the novel?

→ BACKGROUND

∞ Video Link: [What Normal Life Was Like In The 1st Century AD](#) Watch from start to 38:13-end. Finish during exam week or afternoons as needed.

WEEK 12 ☐ 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 24

→ EXAMS ANSWER QUESTION(S) RELATED TO COURSE.
QUESTIONS WILL COME FROM: BRONZE BOW

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

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Term 3

WEEK 1 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 25

The Ancient Church; Peter

Materials: Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times, Historical Atlas of the World

→ INTRO

In the Bronze Bow, you read a historical fiction book about what was happening in the land of Israel during the time of Jesus around 30 AD. This book tells true accounts of the Christians who lived in the 1st century and carried on the message of Jesus after he ascended into heaven. The events in this book take place from 30 AD to 350 AD. This was still a time when the Romans controlled all the areas around the Mediterranean Sea. All the people you will meet lived in Roman occupied territories. Let's first look at a map to understand what the Roman Empire looked like at this time.

→ MAP QUESTIONS

Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World p.16-17

- 1.Name all the bodies of water that surround the Roman Empire, (Atlantic Ocean, Cantabrian Sea, North Sea, Mediterranean Sea, Ligurian Sea, Tyrrhenian Sea, Adriatic Sea, Ionian Sea, Aegean Sea, Adriatic Sea, Black Sea, Red Sea)
- 2.What country was furthest north in the Roman Empire? (Britain)
- 3.What walls were built near the northernmost part of the Roman Empire? (Wall of Hadrian and Wall of Antoninus)
- 4.What country was furthest south in the Roman Republic? (Egypt)
- 5.What country was furthest west in the Roman Republic? (Spain)
- 6.What country was furthest east in the Roman Republic? (Osroene)
- 7.What two rivers in the north formed the borders between the Roman Empire and Germany? (Rhine and Danube)
- 8.Find Jerusalem. That is where the apostles were after the ascension of Jesus.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1.p.11-12 "At not point" - "was increasingly marginalized." Then last paragraph on p. 13 "The story of."

2.We will read about the apostle Peter. What do you remember about him? (He cut off the ear of a soldier when Jesus was arrested in the Garden of Gethsemane, he denied Jesus three times) The event we will read about is told in the Bible in Acts 2. Forty days after the resurrection and tens days after Jesus ascended to heaven, about 120 followers of Christ gathered together in Jerusalem to celebrate a Jewish feast that had been celebrated since the Old Testament.
p. 17-21 "Peter took the" - "And prayed."

• DEFINITIONS

frayed: fragile or uncertain (p.11)

ambassador: representative or messenger (p.11)

marginalized: given an unimportant or powerless position within a society or group (p.12)

zealot: member of a first-century Jewish political movement that fiercely opposed the Roman occupation of Judea (p.20)

WEEK 2 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 26

Peter; begin Paul

Materials: Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

You are reading parts of two chapters today. You will finish the chapter about Peter and find out what happened on the special event we call "The Church's Birthday." Then you will start the section on Paul who was not one of the original twelve apostles of Jesus but was used mightily by God to spread the gospel message.

• DEFINITIONS

gale: a strong current of air (p.21)

Shavuot: Jewish holiday (p.23)

lunacy: insanity, madness (p.29)

orator: (p.29)

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1.p.21-25 "Peter did not know"-end

- Why is this event known as the church's birthday?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Pentecost by Giotto

Many artists have painted scenes of the Holy Spirit coming at Pentecost. Take a moment to look at this painting from Giotto painted around 1310-18. What is the centerpiece of the painting? (dove) What do you notice around the heads of the apostles? Artists traditionally put halos or a glowing rings of light to show a holy or sacred figure. You also notice the "tongues of fire." Do you see the two men outside of the doors? Giotto painted the scene using a low wall to divide those experiencing the event and those straining to hear what was going on.

2.Now we meet the apostle Paul whose story is also told in the Bible. He wrote 13 of the 27 books of the New Testament. His writings were initially letters or epistles written to various churches. The story we are reading today can be found in Acts 16.

p.29-31 "This way!" - "but little comfort."

WEEK 3 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 27

Paul

▢ Materials: Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times, The Student Bible Atlas

→ RECAP

What do you remember about Peter?

→ LOCATE

▢ Map Resource: Map in the book on p.33 or Student Bible Atlas p.20-21 Find Philippi. What country is that part of? (Macedonia) Paul had traveled there on his missionary journeys.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.32-38 (whole chapter)

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: This video from the Bible Project tells more about the life of Paul and his missionary journeys.

WEEK 4 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 28

Persecution of the Church

▢ Materials: Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times

NOTE: We are skipping Fact Files p.39-42 and reading this PDF instead.

→ RECAP

What do you remember about Paul?

→ INTRO

You will read a chapter about why the Romans despised the Christians and how that led to persecution and the killing of Christians.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ PDF Link: Trial by Fire (from The Church of Our Fathers by Roland Bainton) Skip the section about Polycarp p.23-24 "There was a" - "through Jesus Christ."

- What made Christianity so different than the religions of Rome?
- Why do you think so many Christians were willing to die for their faith?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview p.22-23 that talk about Nero's treatment of Christians and the accusation that Christians were cannibals. It may not be appropriate for sensitive students.

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 5 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 29

Ignatius

Materials: Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times, The Student Bible Atlas

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Student Bible Atlas p.20-21

Find Antioch on the east side of the Mediterranean Sea. Why do you think that location would be a good place for trade and the spread of Christianity? Antioch was one of the largest cities in the first-century Roman world, accommodating a population between 100,000 and 300,000. There was a thriving church there made up of Jews and Gentiles and Paul had stayed there for a whole year ministering to the people. (Acts 11) Trace a sea route to Rome that stays close to the coast.

→ INTRO

We will read about Ignatius who was bishop of Antioch (modern-day Turkey) for forty years, probably from AD 67–106. At this time, it was the policy of the Roman government to not to seek out Christians, but still to punish them when they were brought before the authorities. "Once accused and brought before the authorities, Christians had to be forced to worship the gods of the empire, or face punishment... Since great festivities were being planned in Rome in celebration of a military victory, Ignatius was sent to the capital so that his death might provide entertainment for the people. On his way to martyrdom, he wrote seven letters that are among the most valuable documents informing our knowledge of early Christianity" (Justo Gonzalez, The Story of Christianity).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.45-51

- Why do you think he had such courage to face his death?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Links:

1. Fresco of Ignatius of Antioch
2. Inside view of the Colosseum where many Christian were martyred.

WEEK 6 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 30

Polycarp

Materials: Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times, Historical Atlas of the World

→ RECAP

What do you remember about Ignatius?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World p.16-17

Find Smyrna (E5) Where is it located? (In Asia Minor on the coast of the Aegean Sea.)

→ INTRO

We will read about another bishop and martyr of the second century. His name was Polycarp which means 'much fruit' in Greek. Many years earlier than when this account takes place, Ignatius of Antioch had advised young Bishop Polycarp regarding his duties as bishop and the need to be firm in his faith. You may remember that Ignatius wrote 7 letters on his

• DEFINITIONS

dotard: a person exhibiting mental decline especially in old age (p.58)

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

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Term 3

way to Rome. One of those letters was to Polycarp. We will read how Polycarp showed himself a worthy recipient of Ignatius's advice, and a follower of his example.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.53-60

- Did you notice what the Romans called Polycarp? (Roman persecutors called the Christians "atheists" because they refused to worship the Roman gods.) Why is that odd to call him that?
- What do you think about Polycarp's last speech? What does it tell us about his faith?

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Fresco of Polycarp

WEEK 7 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 31

Cyprian

 Materials: Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times

→ RECAP

What did you remember about Polycarp?

→ LOCATE

 Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World p.16-17

Find Carthage (F7) Where is it located? (In Africa on the Mediterranean Sea.)

→ INTRO

Cyprian was the bishop of the church in Carthage from 248 to 258 AD. His writings and teachers have been beneficial to Christians. He helped Christians navigate the question: Do we let people who denied Christ under the threat of torture and death back into the church if they repent?

→ BACKGROUND

In AD 250 the most violent persecution the church had yet faced was instigated by the emperor Decius (249–51). Decius was determined to have no nonsense from Christians. In his eyes, they were enemies of the empire. Their atheism was responsible for the many troubles in the realm. Thus Decius commanded all citizens of the empire to sacrifice to the traditional Roman gods. Those who did so were given certificates (*libelli* in Latin) as evidence that they had obeyed the order. Those who refused to comply and were unable (or unwilling) to obtain false *libelli* from sympathetic or corrupt officials faced death. To save their lives, many Christians complied. Others were able to obtain certificates without having actually sacrificed. But an unknown number of Christians were imprisoned or executed—among them the bishops of Rome, Antioch, and Jerusalem. (Church History in Plain Language)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.63-78 Stop at "a different approach."

- How important is it for Christians to be part of a church body and to attend church regularly? What do you think Cyprian was saying about that topic?
- Why do you think there was disagreement on whether those who denied their faith should be let back in the church?

→ VIEW

This is a mosaic that is on the wall in a church in Ravenna, Italy that was constructed in the 6th century. A mosaic is a pattern or image made of small regular or irregular pieces of colored stone or glass held in place by plaster and covering a surface. Mosaics are often used as floor and wall

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

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decoration, and were particularly popular in the ancient Roman world. On this wall is a procession of martyrs walking from the king's palace towards Christ's throne in heaven. In the other image you can see the inside of the church. Polycarp was also represented in this mosaic.

∞ Image Links: Mosaic of Cyprian, Inside of Basilica of Sant'Apollinare Nuovo

WEEK 8 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 32
Cyprian/Fact Files

Materials: Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times

→ RECAP

What do you remember about Cyprian from last time?

→ INTRO

We are going to finish up the section on Cyprian and then we will read more about some of the practices of the early church that we still follow today. We left off with Cyprian talking about the dilemma the church had about whether they should let people back into the church if they denied Christ during the persecution. Cyprian believed the Lord called for a different approach.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

1.p.68-74 "I was wondering" - "Tertullian, and Origen."

• What do you think about Cyprians

2.(Optional) p.75-76

3.The Apostles Creed

∞ Image Link: The Apostles Creed

• DEFINITIONS

eucharist: communion (p.70)

WEEK 9 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 33
Constantine

Materials: Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ INTRO

When Diocletian became emperor, he thought the empire too large for one man to manage, and for that reason divided different sections out to assistant emperors. When he grew old and retired, the assistant emperors began to quarrel, and their sons as well. Constantine was the son of one, Maxentius was the son of another. Constantine held Britain and Gaul (France). Maxentius held Rome and Italy. Constantine wanted to conquer Maxentius and take control of Rome. We will read about what happened during that battle that finally brought an end to the persecution of Christians.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.79-86 "We are camping" - "move at daybreak."

→ VIEW

∞ Image Link: Chi-Ro Symbol used in ancient Roman Empire
Emperor Constantine used the Chi-Rho symbol on his shields and coinage after his conversion and it was used as a Christian symbol for many centuries on tomb stones, mosaics, cups, tiles and manuscripts. It is made from two Greek letters (X and ρ). They are the first two letters of the word Christ and this symbol came to represent Christ, or Christianity.

• IMPORTANT DATES

313 Edict of Milan that ended persecution

• DEFINITIONS

reconnaissance: military activity in which soldiers are sent to find out information about an enemy (p.79)

prone: lying flat (p.81)

augur: (one held to foretell events by omens (p.84)

pacifist: a person who opposes war or warlike policies (p.85)

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

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WEEK 10 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 34

Finish Constantine/Athanasius

Materials: Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times, Historical Atlas of the World

Note: This lesson is broken into two sections.

→ RECAP

What did you read last time about Constantine?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.86-88 "The battle progressed" - "the next chapter."

→ INTRO

Athanasius is an important person from church history who lived from 293-373 in Alexandria, Egypt, which was part of the Roman Empire. He is known as the Father of Orthodoxy. Do you know what orthodoxy means? It comes from two Greek words. Orthos means right, true, and straight. Doxa means opinion. It refers to true religious beliefs. Athanasius helped Christians understand that Jesus is fully God and fully man. At that time there was a man named Arius who argued that the Father alone was truly God and that the Son was the first and greatest creature made by the Father.

That is not biblical. Athanasius defended the truth even when it was hard. What would it mean if Jesus was not truly God?

→ MAP WORK

Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.18-19

1. Find Alexandria on the map. What country is it located in?
2. What bodies of water are near this city?
3. Why would this be a good location for a bustling city?
4. Based on the name of this city, who might the founder be? It was founded by Alexander the Great in 331 B.C. It was later taken over by the Roman Emperor Octavius. Athanasius lived in this important city.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.91- top of 95 "The battle progressed" - "the speakers forth."

• DEFINITIONS

queries: a question or a request for information about something (p.93)

WEEK 11 25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 35

Finish Athanasius

Materials: Redemption: The Church in Ancient Times, Historical Atlas of the World

→ RECAP

What did you read last time?

→ LOCATE

Map Resource: Historical Atlas of the World, p.16-17

1. Today we will read about a council of bishops that came to Nicea. Find Nicea on the map. (EG) What ancient country was it located in?
2. What modern country is it located in? (Turkey)
3. What bodies of water are near this city? Why would this be a good location for a council for people to travel to from various parts of the Roman Empire?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

p.95-99 "It took Eusebius" - "of Jesus Christ."
(Optional) p.100-103

• IMPORTANT DATES

325 Council of Nicea

Ancient History: Grades 5-6

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→ **PROMPT**

∞ Image Link: Image of Athanasius

WEEK 12  **25m Ancient History: Grades 5-6 - Lesson 36**

→ **EXAMS ANSWER QUESTION(S) RELATED TO COURSE.**

QUESTIONS WILL COME FROM: REDEMPTION: THE CHURCH IN ANCIENT TIMES